Bulletin

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GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

- **Why cheaper fibre fees fail to spark Nigerian infrastructure investment** — TechCabal, 19 October 2026
  NIGERIA

  A TechCabal analysis of Nigerian Communications Commission portal data from July 2026 finds that state right-of-way fees do not neatly predict where fibre has been built. Ogun charges up to ₦6,600 per metre yet has 4,246 km of fibre, while Jigawa and Zamfara, which waive the fee, have 970 km and 1,101 km. The piece notes that construction costs and other factors are not captured in the portal data. *Also under Connectivity*.

Legislation and regulation

- **رئيس مجلس الوزراء يصدر قراراً بتشكيل الآلية الوطنية لمكافحة جرائم المعلوماتية** — Sudan News Agency (SUNA), 19 October 2026
  SUDAN

  Sudan's prime minister issued a decision on 19 October 2026 forming a National Mechanism to Combat Informatics Crimes, chaired by an assistant attorney general. It is tasked with combating cybercrime and publications deemed harmful to the state and society, monitoring media and social platforms, and taking preventive and legal action, including lawsuits on the state's behalf. *Also under Cybersecurity*.

- **Mauritius' SIL signs MoU with TCS to strengthen digital transformation** — TechAfrica News, 19 October 2026
  MAURITIUS

  Mauritius' State Informatics Ltd signed a memorandum of understanding with India's Tata Consultancy Services on digital transformation, technology cooperation and innovation. IT Minister Avinash Ramtohul said it would support knowledge transfer and local digital skills, and he pointed to the planned AI City and the automation of public-sector workflows. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov and Training and skills*.

- **Gabon : l'identification formelle des utilisateurs de réseaux sociaux devient obligatoire** — Gabon Media Time, 19 October 2026 GABON

  Gabon's law 003/2026 of 5 October 2026, published on 9 October, requires individuals and legal entities using social networks and online platforms to formally identify themselves. Gabon Media Time reports that article 4 does not say what documents are needed, how identity will be checked or how existing accounts are treated. It also does not make the personal identification number mandatory for this purpose. *Also under Data protection and Digital Identity and CRVS*.

- **Dr Hervé Tiwa : « Il y a un vide juridique actuellement qu'il faut combler »** — Digital Business Africa, 19 October 2026 CAMEROON

In an interview with Digital Business Africa, digital transformation and AI expert Hervé Tiwa argues that Cameroon has a legal gap on AI and should fill it. He favours a broader digital law that absorbs the cybercrime law rather than a separate law for each new technology, with clear prohibitions against misuse such as disinformation and deepfakes. *Also under AI and Public debate and participation in policymaking.*

Data protection

- **Liberian MPs begin scrutinizing PPP concession deal for new national ID** — Biometric Update, 19 October 2026 LIBERIA

  Liberia's House of Representatives referred a proposed $52 million build-operate-transfer concession for a national ID and civil registration system to a joint committee on 16 October 2026, giving it two weeks to report. The system would hold records for up to 10 million people, and civil society groups are asking for scrutiny of the financial terms and data protection. The National Identification Registry says fewer than 800,000 people hold a national ID. *Also under Digital Identity and CRVS and Registries.*

- **'You didn't need to bypass any access controls': Gauteng eGov weighs charges over e-panic button flaw** — The Citizen, 19 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  Gauteng's e-Government department said on 19 October 2026 it will decide whether to pursue criminal charges against student Joel Cedras, who exposed a flaw in the e-Panic Button app, once an investigation report due the following week is in. The DA's Michael Waters said the department had sought his prosecution, and that police advised the app's developers would have to open the case. *Also under Cybersecurity.*

- **Gabon : l'identification formelle des utilisateurs de réseaux sociaux devient obligatoire** — Gabon Media Time, 19 October 2026 GABON

  Summarised under Legislation and regulation.

Regional collaboration

- **Smart Africa moves cross-border digital ID interoperability toward live testing** — Biometric Update, 19 October 2026 BENIN GHANA RWANDA AFRICA

  Benin, Ghana and Rwanda have connected their national identity systems through the Smart Africa Data Exchange and are moving toward real-world testing of cross-border ID verification, Biometric Update reported on 19 October 2026. Pilots are planned for Benin-Rwanda air travel and Ghana-Benin land crossings. No date for live testing has been announced. *Also under Digital Identity and CRVS and Data Exchange.*

Public debate and participation in policymaking

- **The Missing Plumbing of the State: Why Ghana's Next Digital Leap Depends on a Whole-of-Government Data Exchange** — Imani Africa, 19 October 2026 GHANA

  John Sitsofe Mensah, an IMANI associate, argues that Ghana needs a whole-of-government data exchange to connect state databases, now that identity and payment systems are in place. He warns against agencies hosting core records on offshore cloud servers instead of the national government cloud run by NITA, citing legal, sovereignty and vendor lock-in risks. He also says a single exchange would stop citizens being asked for information the state already holds. *Also under Data Exchange, Digital sovereignty and Data Storage.*

- **Altas taxas cobradas no novo Centro Pronto para BI, passaporte, carta de condução e DIRE revoltam cidadãos** — MZNews, 19 October 2026 MOZAMBIQUE

Fees at Mozambique's new Centro Pronto document centre have drawn public anger, as the private centre adds its own fee and 16% VAT to the state fee. An adult identity-card renewal costs MZN 1,058.12 in total, of which the state fee is MZN 160. A driving-licence renewal costs MZN 5,201.84 and an express passport renewal MZN 10,725.10. *Also under Digital Identity and CRVS and Access to services.*

- **Dr Hervé Tiwa : « Il y a un vide juridique actuellement qu'il faut combler »** — Digital Business Africa, 19 October 2026 CAMEROON

  Summarised under Legislation and regulation.

Finance

Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure

- **Seychelles targets 2027 start for digital system to modernise public service** — Seychelles News Agency, 19 October 2026 SEYCHELLES

  Seychelles plans to begin implementing a digital human resource management system in 2027, Vice-President Sebastien Pillay announced after meeting Canadian vendor FreeBalance at State House on 14 October 2026. The system would cover employee records, payroll, performance management and workforce analytics. Pillay said technology alone would not improve efficiency unless administrative procedures are also reviewed. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov.*

MoUs and other agreements

- **Togo Signs Huawei Agreement to Modernize Energy, Transport and Customs** — Togo First, 19 October 2026 TOGO

  Togo and Huawei signed a memorandum of understanding in Shenzhen on 16 October 2026 covering energy, smart transport and smart customs systems. It includes technology transfer and local skills development, and was signed during Council President Faure Gnassingbé's visit to China from 9 to 16 October. No value was given. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov and China activities.*

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

- **Libya's O3 Group Unveils Digital Infrastructure Plans After Medusa Cable Landing** — TechAfrica News, 19 October 2026 LIBYA

  Libya's O3 Group, a private telecoms company founded in 2024 and based in Benghazi, set out its infrastructure plans as the Medusa submarine cable made its first Libyan landing at Benghazi on 17 October 2026. The plans include a 12,000 to 13,000 km national fibre network, a Tier III data centre in Benghazi and a mobile service. A second Medusa landing is planned for Tripoli. *Also under Data Storage.*

- **Camtel, Socadel explore infrastructure sharing deal** — ITWeb Africa, 19 October 2026 CAMEROON

  Cameroon's Camtel and electricity utility Socadel signed a memorandum of understanding in Yaoundé on 16 October 2026 to study infrastructure sharing. It would pair Camtel's national fibre backbone with Socadel's poles and rights-of-way to extend fibre along overhead power lines. Feasibility studies and pilot sites come next.

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Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

Data Storage

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- **Libya's O3 Group Unveils Digital Infrastructure Plans After Medusa Cable Landing** — TechAfrica News, 19 October 2026 LIBYA

  Summarised under Connectivity.

Technical Capacity

- **Le ministre de l'Enseignement supérieur et de la Recherche scientifique préside une séance de travail consacrée à la mobilisation des financements nationaux et au développement des infrastructures de calcul haute performance et d'intelligence artificielle** — Ministère de l'Enseignement supérieur et de la Recherche scientifique (Algérie), 19 October 2026 ALGERIA

  Algeria's higher-education ministry agreed on 19 October 2026 with public and private companies to set up a joint framework for drafting a 2030 roadmap to finance GPU-based high-performance computing and AI research capacity. Its four aims are company co-funding of GPUs, research steered to economic needs, a stronger national AI and data centre, and recruiting diaspora talent. *Also under AI and Research institutions.*

Cybersecurity

- **رئيس مجلس الوزراء يصدر قراراً بتشكيل الآلية الوطنية لمكافحة جرائم المعلوماتية** — Sudan News Agency (SUNA), 19 October 2026 SUDAN

  Summarised under Legislation and regulation.

- **'You didn't need to bypass any access controls': Gauteng eGov weighs charges over e-panic button flaw** — The Citizen, 19 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  Summarised under Data protection.

DPI

Data Exchange

- **Open tender — Eastern Africa Regional Digital Integration Project: Design, Deployment and Operationalization of the Government API Gateway, Government Single Sign-On (SSO) and National Digital Government Portal — for Somalia by WB in Public Sector Governance, ICT & Telecommunications sectors —** — DevelopmentAid, 19 October 2026 SOMALIA

  Somalia invited expressions of interest on 19 October 2026 for the design, deployment and operation of a government API gateway, a government single sign-on system and a national digital government portal. The work falls under the World Bank-financed Eastern Africa Regional Digital Integration Project. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov.*

- **The Missing Plumbing of the State: Why Ghana's Next Digital Leap Depends on a Whole-of-Government Data Exchange** — Imani Africa, 19 October 2026 GHANA

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  Summarised under Regional collaboration.

Digital Identity and CRVS

- **Somalia plans unified digital government platform built around national ID** — Biometric Update, 19 October 2026 SOMALIA

  Somalia's Unified Public Service Delivery Center, known as Halmeel, plans to launch a unified digital government services platform by the end of March 2027, starting with about 70 services. The national ID will be the only accepted credential, its director general told Biometric Update. Halmeel, created by Cabinet resolution on 23 April, is integrating with the national ID agency NIRA, which had about 2 million people registered as of October 2026. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov*.

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Digital Payments and Fintech

- **Open tender — CAR- Public Sector Digital Governance Project: Acquisition des Kits pour la mise en place d'agent de monnaie mobile — for Central African Republic by WB in ICT & Telecommunications sector —** — DevelopmentAid, 19 October 2026 CAR

  The Central African Republic opened an invitation for bids on 19 October 2026 for goods: kits to set up mobile money agents. The tender falls under the World Bank-financed Public Sector Digital Governance Project. No budget is stated and no award has been made. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov*.

- **Onafriq tried to sell its Nigerian agent banking business before shutdown** — TechCabal, 19 October 2026 NIGERIA

  Onafriq had been negotiating the sale of Baxi, its Nigerian agent-banking business, before it announced a shutdown on 16 October 2026, according to UK-filed accounts approved on 29 July 2026. The accounts record a non-binding memorandum of terms for a full divestment, agency services revenue down 56% to $13.4 million in 2024, and ₦19.9 billion in overdrafts owed to Zenith Bank and Stanbic IBTC. *Also under ICT Industry*.

- **Mastercard and Moovn sign five-year deal to expand digital payments across East Africa** — TechAfrica News, 19 October 2026 KENYA TANZANIA

Mastercard and Moovn Technologies signed a five-year agreement, announced on 19 October 2026, to add Mastercard prepaid cards, tokenisation, online acceptance, Pay Local and cross-border transfers to the MoovnPay wallet. Pay Local is to expand across Kenya and Tanzania, and the Shooga prepaid Mastercard portfolio is to launch next. *Also under ICT Industry*.

Registries

- **Liberian MPs begin scrutinizing PPP concession deal for new national ID** — Biometric Update, 19 October 2026 LIBERIA

  Summarised under Data protection.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

- **GOVT PLANS AI SERVICES AT YOUR FINGERTIPS** — Eswatini Positive News, 19 October 2026 ESWATINI

  Eswatini's ICT ministry presented a proposed platform for reaching government services and payments by mobile device at the Global AI & Digital Summit in Seoul on 19 October 2026. No implementation date was announced. The ministry also cited digital-skills targets of 300,000 citizens through a UAE partnership and 200,000 through a World Bank-supported initiative. *Also under Training and skills and AI*.

- **Gabon/Sécurité alimentaire : l'AGASA lancera la plateforme numérique Nexus le 2 novembre prochain - AGP - Agence Gabonaise de Presse** — Agence Gabonaise de Presse, 19 October 2026 GABON

  Gabon's food safety agency AGASA will launch Nexus, a digital platform for food and plant-health operators, on 2 November 2026. Operators will be able to apply remotely for approvals, import authorisations and health certificates, and track their files. Operators are asked to visit AGASA offices from 20 to 29 October with identity documents to update their data and get login details.

- **BMA vehicle crime crackdown shifts into digital gear** — ITWeb South Africa, 19 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  South Africa's Border Management Authority launched its Vehicle Targeting System at Lebombo Port of Entry on 18 October 2026. It reports 83 vehicles worth R46.6 million recovered in the six months since the system went live at land ports on 1 April 2026, with rollout to eight land ports planned by the end of February 2027.

- **Togo Signs Huawei Agreement to Modernize Energy, Transport and Customs** — Togo First, 19 October 2026 TOGO

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- **Seychelles targets 2027 start for digital system to modernise public service** — Seychelles News Agency, 19 October 2026 SEYCHELLES

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Technology

AI

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ICT Industry

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Capacity

Training and skills

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Research institutions

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Inclusion

Access to services

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Data

National statistics

- **Minister of Planning & Economic Development, Statistician-General and UNFPA Country Representative Undertake Joint Monitoring Visit to 2026 Mock Population and Housing Census Area** — Statistics Sierra Leone, 19 October 2026 SIERRA LEONE

  Sierra Leone's planning minister, the Statistician-General and UNFPA's country representative monitored the 2026 mock census enumeration at Hill Station, Freetown, on 19 October 2026. The mock census is testing census methods, the digital data-collection system and quality assurance ahead of the national census scheduled for December 2026, Statistics Sierra Leone said.

Geopolitics

China activities

- **Togo Signs Huawei Agreement to Modernize Energy, Transport and Customs** — Togo First, 19 October 2026 TOGO

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Digital sovereignty

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ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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This bulletin is produced automatically at the end of each data collection sweep but only includes items published on the day cited in the edition, and the previous day. Items published in the last month can be found on the country pages. The links to all items stored in the corpus can be found in the catalogue.

Bulletins are kept for a week — the last week's editions are listed above, each at its own dated address — and are then deleted. Older material is in the country and region news.